

The Future is a ...Pixel?

When Google announced that they were shutting down the Nexus branding, the whole world was distraught. While none of the reference tablets except the Nexus 7 were a huge runaway success, they were still interesting devices in their own right. But as it turned out, it was more of a closing of a chapter and the starting of a new one. Enter the Pixel C.

Google's announcement of the Pixel C in September 2015 was a bold move. It was Google indirectly saying that a hardware OEM, even when working in close collaboration with Google themselves, couldn't really express what Google wanted in a device. So, Google decided to take matters into its own hands. This is the second Pixel product, after the Chromebook Pixel, where Google developed both the hardware and the software to complement it, in house. This way they could have all the creative liberties they want to develop the product according to their wishes as well as focus on the synergizing the high-end hardware and software for performance and therefore, also exuding a premium feeling (Apple had trained the public to expect nothing else).



Absolutely Premium

The Pixel is a beautiful device, with a metal unibody that's unblemished by any marking or branding whatsoever except a thin bar in 'Google colors' near the top. It's thin slate of fused glass and metal that's built very, very well and feels premium just the way an iPad does. It has a docking slot on the bottom for the keyboard and was also one of the first tablets to use the USB C charging standard. It has a 10.2 inch screen with a resolution of 2560*1800 and a pixel density of 308 ppi. What's totally unique to the Pixel

C is its aspect ratio. Instead of going the traditional 16:9 / 16:10, Google went with a totally new 1:√2 screen ratio (Basically, the ratio a sheet of A4 paper has) Their reasoning is that this allowed for better viewing experience in portrait mode. On the inside, the Pixel C managed to pack in a Nvidia Tegra X1 SoC with 3 gigs of RAM – while remaining at about 7 mm of thickness but compromised by densing up to become pretty much the heaviest tablet amongst the competition.